CALLUM **WITTEN**

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Kavli Institute for Cosmology, University of Cambridge, United Kingdom

Education

October 2021–October 2024	**PhD**, Astronomy Institute of Astronomy, University of Cambridge New insights into primeval galaxies in the era of JWST Supervisors: Prof Debora Sijacki and Dr Nicolas Laporte
2017–2021	**MPhys**, First class, Physics with Astrophysics University of Bath

Research Experience

September 2026–Present	**Postdoctoral Researcher**, University of Cambridge Kavli Institute for Cosmology, Roberto Maiolino
November 2024–August 2026	**Postdoctoral Researcher**, University of Geneva Observatory of Geneva, Pascal Oesch

Summary of Publications

Publications: 36 total (8 first author), of which 27 refereed (7 first author). ADS link.
Bibliometrics: 1,886 total citations (282 first author), h-index of 21. Last updated 14/10/2026.

Collaboration Memberships

Lumina simulations protocluster lead · VLT/MOONS extragalactic GTO team · ELT/MOSAIC science team · GTC/EMIR commissioning team

Summary of Observing Time

Four PI (nineteen Co-I) proposals, total of ~ 100 hrs on *JWST* and the VLT.

Accepted PI Proposals

2024	**VLT P114** · **XSHOOTER Spectroscopy** **C. Witten** · 275V · The first structures in the Universe: unveiling the properties of the most distant ionised bubble at $z = 7.9$ · 25 hours
2024	**VLT P113** · **KMOS Spectroscopy** **C. Witten** · 26C0 · The properties of galaxies residing within an ionised bubble and protocluster at $z \sim 7$ · 24.5 hours
2023	**JWST Cycle 2** · **NIRCam WFSS** **C. Witten** · 4043 · Unveiling the build-up of large scale structure in the early Universe · 19.9 hours
2023	**VLT P112** · **KMOS Spectroscopy** **C. Witten** · 25RJ · The properties of galaxies residing within an ionised bubble and protocluster at $z \sim 7$ · 24.5 hours

Awards and Funding
(converted to USD)

2026	**SNF Grant** Awarded to facilitate the Miracles of the early Universe II conference **$18,400**
2025	**Murdin Prize** Best publication by a PhD student **$700**
2024	**JWST Grant Funding** Program 4043 **$69,800**
2024	**IoA Summer Internship Bursary** Funding to host a summer intern **$4,700**
2023	**Wolfson Research Grant** Award to attend conferences **$1,600**
2021–2024	**STFC PhD Studentship** Competitively awarded by the IoA, Cambridge **$84,000**

Supervision and Teaching Experience

2026	Guest lecture Galaxies and Cosmology · *Cosmic Microwave Background*
2025–2026	Supervision of a Master's research project (full-time duration: 9 months) **Corentin Meuwly** (Geneva) · *Unveiling the lifecycle of the earliest galaxies in the Universe with JWST*
2025	Supervision of a Master's research project (full-time duration: 2 weeks) **Parker Fairfield** (Geneva) · *Deciphering the origins of the UV emission from the enigmatic Little Red Dots*
2025	Lecture Saas-Fee winter school · *JWST workshop*
2023–2024	Supervision of a Master's research project and summer internship **Billy Hayes** (Cambridge) · *Hunting for evidence of the first galaxies hidden in JWST data*
2021–2023	Supervision of Master's and Bachelor's student problem classes 26 students · *Formation of Structure in the Universe, Stellar Dynamics and Structure of Galaxies*

Conferences and Seminars

Twenty-two contributed and five invited talks (plus one upcoming) at prestigious conferences.

Talk Highlights

May 2027	**Sendai, Japan** · **Panoramic Views of Galaxy Cluster Assembly** *Invited talk (upcoming)* · Development of cosmic structures from initial fluctuations to the present-day clusters
August 2026	**Santander, Spain** · **Collaborative Frontiers in Extragalactic Astronomy** *Invited talk* · Resolving the overabundance of protoclusters in the early Universe
December 2025	**Marseille, France** · **Seminar** *Invited talk* · Extreme environments in the early Universe
July 2025	**Heidelberg, Germany** · **Quo Vadis Galaxy Evolution?** *Contributed Talk* · Protoclusters in the early Universe: Powerhouses behind ionised bubbles and evolved galaxies

April 2025	**Oxford, UK** · **First Galaxies: Building blocks of galaxies across cosmic time** *Contributed Talk* · An evolved protocluster in the early Universe
August 2024	**Ascona, Switzerland** · **Observing and Simulating Galaxy Evolution in the Era of JWST** *Contributed Talk* · Evidence of old stellar populations and rejuvenation events in the very early Universe
July 2023	**Sesto, Italy** · **The James Webb Space Telescope turns one: the birth and growth of galaxies** *Contributed Talk* · Unveiling the drivers of LAEs at $z > 7$

Professional Service

2026	**SOC Chair** NAM 2026 session: Forging stars and galaxies in the first billion years
2026	**SOC Chair** EAS 2026 special session: From molecular clouds to galaxy clusters: towards a unified understanding of stochastic star formation in the early Universe
2026	**SOC & LOC Chair** Miracles of the early Universe II conference, 50 people in Geneva
2026	**LOC Member** Beyond Hubble 2026 Conference
2025	**SOC & LOC Chair** Miracles of the early Universe conference, 40 people in Geneva
Since 2025	**Referee** for Nature Astronomy
Since 2025	**Referee** for A&A
Since 2023	**Referee** for ApJ
Since 2023	**Referee** for MNRAS

Press Releases and Outreach

May 2026	**A&A Cover Image** Volume 709
July 2024	**New Scientist Article** Zombie galaxy came back to life after 20 million years
Spring 2024	**Mexborough & Swinton Astronomical Society** Invited to speak to a public astronomical society about results from JWST
January 2024	**New Scientist Article** Galaxy smash-ups may explain strange light from early universe
January 2024	**ESA Press Release** Webb reveals that galaxy mergers are the solution to early Universe mystery
January 2024	**Nature Research Briefing** Galaxy mergers can explain the unexpected hydrogen emission in the early Universe
August 2022	**Buckland Primary School, Oxfordshire** Astronomy engagement talk for 10-11 year old school children